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MySQL CHECK Constraint

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MySQL CHECK Constraint

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The `CHECK` constraint is used to ensure that the values in a column satisfies a specific condition.

The `CHECK` constraint evaluates the data to TRUE or FALSE. If the data evaluates to TRUE, the operation is ok. If the data evaluates to FALSE, the entire INSERT or UPDATE operation is aborted, and an error is raised.

CHECK Constraint on CREATE TABLE

The following SQL creates a `CHECK` constraint on the "Age" column upon creation of the "Persons" table.

Here, the `CHECK` constraint ensures that the "Age" column must have a value of 18, or above:

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```
    LastName varchar(255) NOT NULL,
    FirstName varchar(255),
    Age int CHECK (Age >= 18)
);
```

Naming a CHECK Constraint

To name a `CHECK` constraint, or to define a `CHECK` constraint on multiple columns, use the following SQL syntax:

```
CREATE TABLE Persons (
    ID int PRIMARY KEY,
    LastName varchar(255) NOT NULL,
    FirstName varchar(255),
    Age int,
    City varchar(255),
    CONSTRAINT chk_PersonAge CHECK (Age >= 18 AND City = 'Sandnes')
);
```

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To create a `CHECK` constraint on the "Age" column when the table is already created, use the following SQL:

```
ALTER TABLE Persons
ADD CHECK (Age >= 18);
```

Naming a CHECK Constraint

To name a `CHECK` constraint, and to define a `CHECK` constraint on multiple columns, use the following SQL syntax:

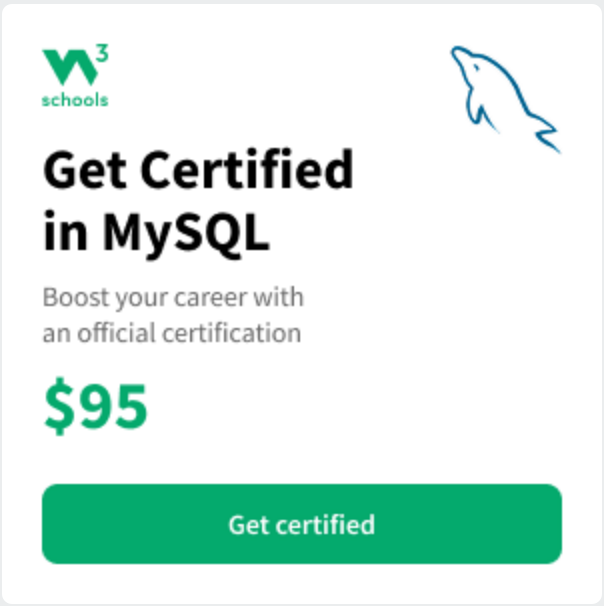
```
ALTER TABLE Persons
ADD CONSTRAINT chk_PersonAge CHECK (Age >= 18 AND City = 'Sandnes');
```

Drop a CHECK Constraint

To drop a `CHECK` constraint, use the following SQL:

```
ALTER TABLE Persons
DROP CHECK chk_PersonAge;
```

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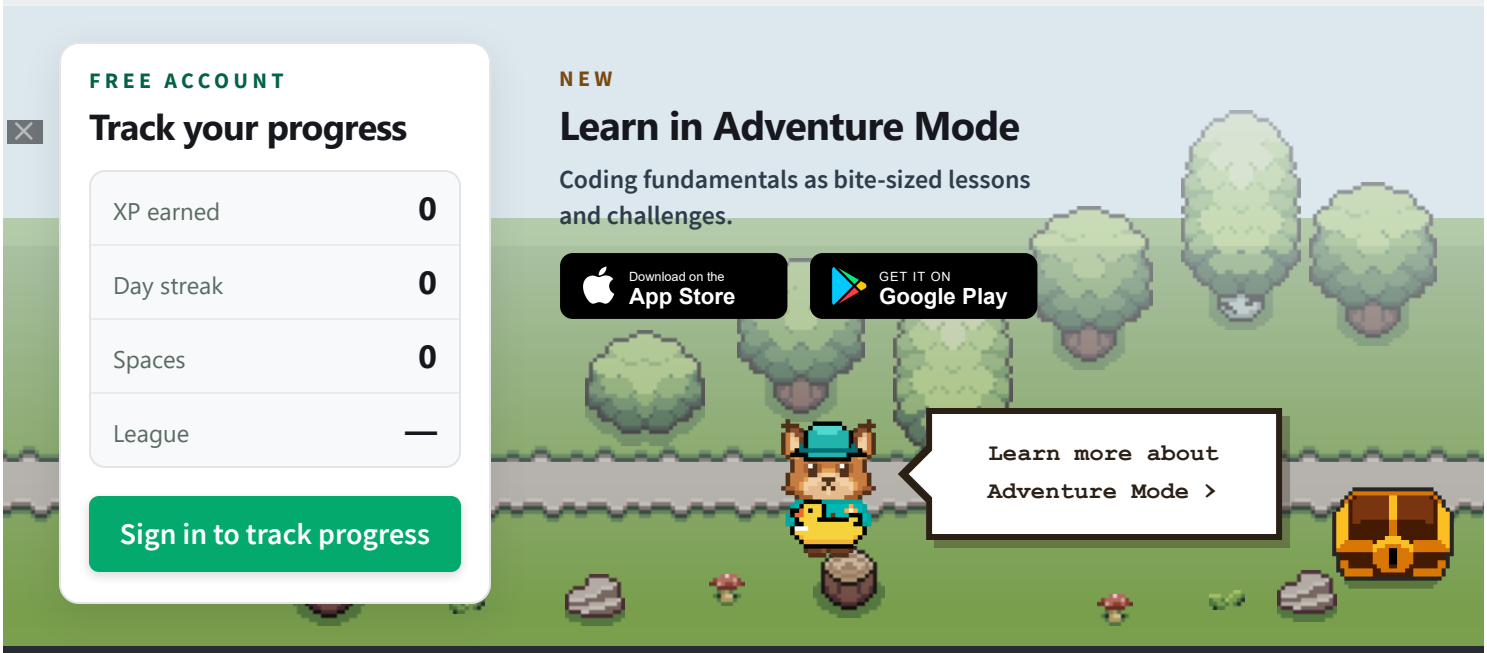
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